

Data-Driven Decision Making: Building a Thriving University

Objective:

Identify actionable strategies for improvement



The Request:

Charged with creating a competitive program in the face of limited resources, Washington Adventist University's (WAU) new President created The Plan—a [strategic vision](#) outlining a massive restructuring initiative. WAU, a private university, sought Hanover's services to analyze data and provide recommendations on the action-items within this plan to guide their ultimate goal: to revitalize brand reputation through improved student outcomes.



Approach:

Determine high-impact, low-cost, targeted change to guide institutional plan of action



The Research:

Over the course of their three-year partnership, Hanover has collaborated with WAU on 38 research studies to determine high-impact, feasible solutions that supported a culture of excellence.

Hanover Research produced actionable insights and concrete recommendations for WAU by:

- Increasing their competitive status within the higher education landscape through the active pursuit of funding;
- Analyzing graduate and employee satisfaction surveys, learning outcomes, and enrollment data to guide The Plan's strategic goals;
- Generating new ideas for curriculum innovation, enhanced support services, and institutional structure and development.



Results:

Advanced student outcomes and brand perception



The Outcome:

Since 2008, retention is up 72% and graduation rates are up by 40%.

The solutions facilitated by Hanover equipped WAU with the insight needed to guide this transformation. WAU has succeeded in implementing vast institutional improvements since The Plan's launch. The university is now on sound fiscal ground due to a host of revitalized outcomes and enhanced offerings.



**Weymouth Spence, Ed.D., R.T.,
University President**

"As an Institution, we can't always be the first to do things; but at the same time we can't be last. Hanover has provided us with the research to inform our future while keeping us on track to make data-driven decisions into the 21st century...This data can both sustain us and help us to thrive."